ICT MENTORSHIP CORE CONTENT

ICT MENTORSHIP CORE CONTENT - MONTH 07 - SHORT TERM TRADING MARKET MAKER MANIPULATION TEMPLATES

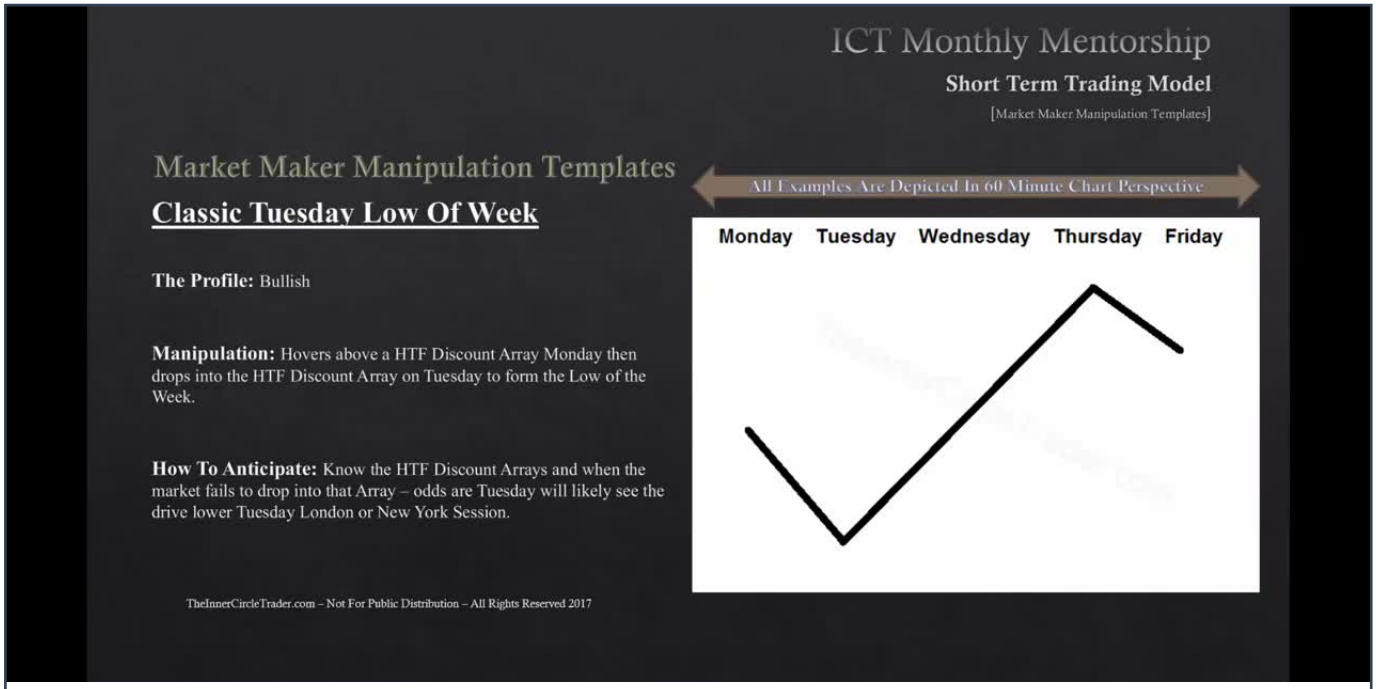
This lesson focuses on Market Maker Manipulation Templates for short-term trading. It builds upon the weekly profiles discussed in Lesson 2, which generally classify how the market unfolds.

While not every subtle nuance is covered, these templates, combined with the weekly profiles, provide insight into how market manipulation takes place. The goal is to blend these ideas to understand why the market moves as it does in specific weekly profiles, enabling a forecast of market maker actions based on current market conditions.

All examples and diagrams are depicted as 60-Minute charts, representing the general theme of market trading from Monday through Friday when viewed on a one-hour chart basis.

CLASSIC TUESDAY LOW OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 1 (LIQUIDITY POOL)

TIMESTAMP: 00:01:53



This template is for a primarily bullish market.

- The market trades down on Tuesday into a discount.

- This discount comes in the form of an old monthly, weekly, or daily low.

- The purpose is to run a liquidity pool, specifically running out sell stops.

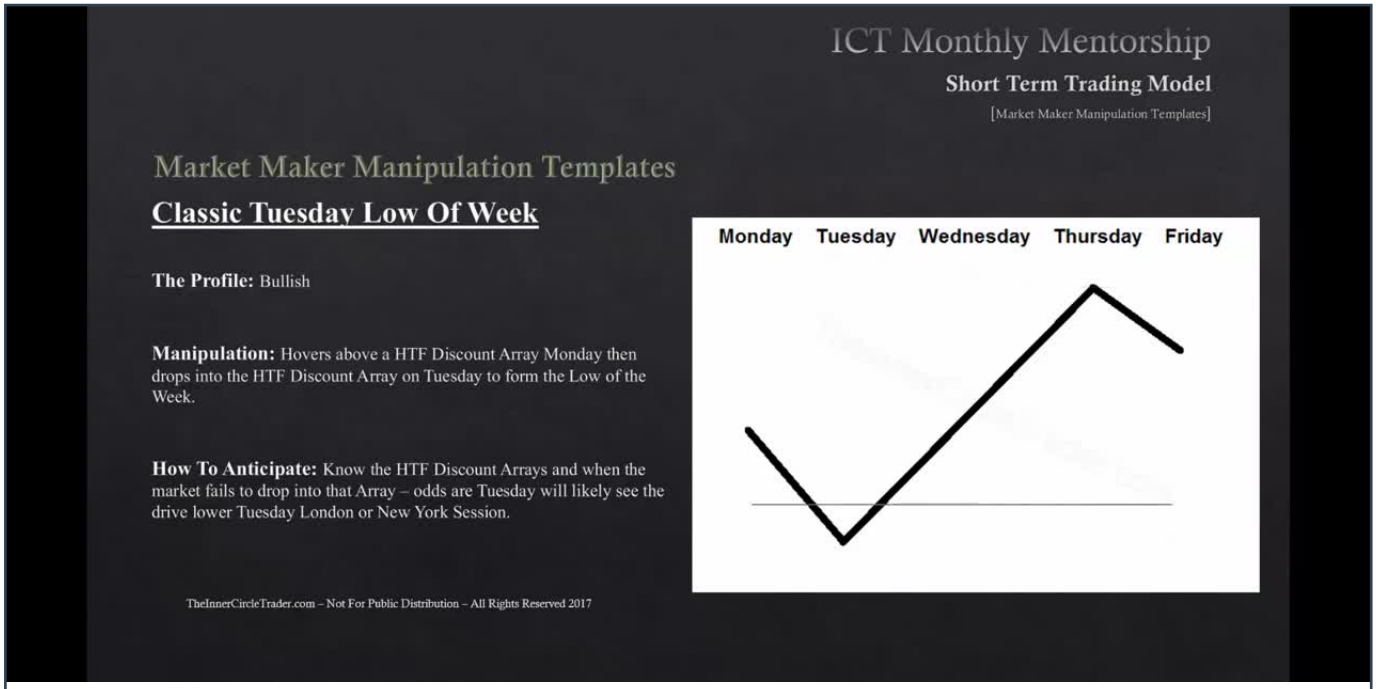
- The high of the week is generally formed by Thursday's New York session, potentially carrying over into Friday, but primarily look for Thursday as the highest portion of the weekly range.

- The market is expected to trade up into a premium Market PD (Price Delivery) array.

- Key: Look for a time frame lesser than the discount liquidity pool used to buy off of. For example, if buying off a monthly liquidity pool, target a weekly or daily premium PD array.

CLASSIC TUESDAY LOW OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 2 (RETEST OF OLD HIGH AS SUPPORT)

TIMESTAMP: 00:03:11



This is another scenario for a Classic Tuesday Low of the Week, again in a bullish market condition.

- The market trades down to an old monthly, weekly, or daily high.

- This means the market has already broken out above a historical or old high.

- The market then comes back and retests that area as support.

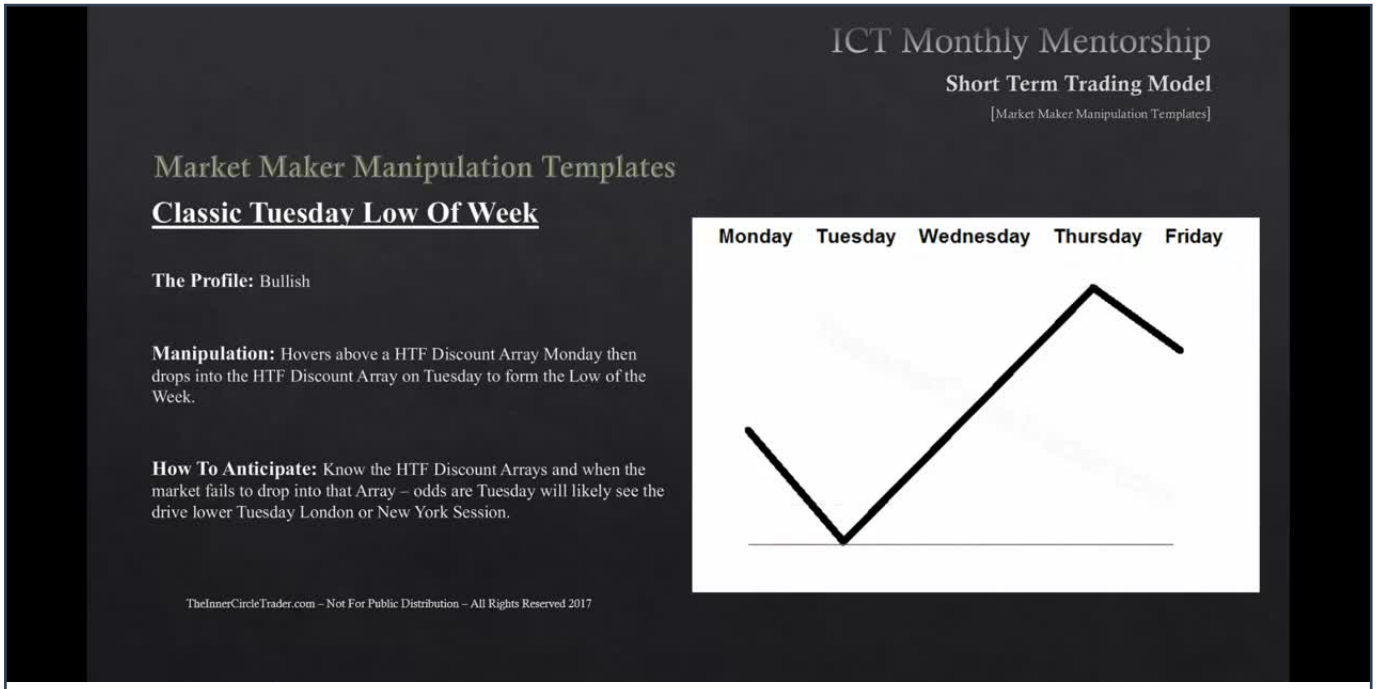
- Expect the market to trade up into a premium PD array and/or a Fibonacci (Fib) extension combination.

- Fib extension targets: 127 percent or 168 percent extensions, or a 100 percent symmetrical price swing (perfect Market structure swing).

- This premium Market PD array and overlapping Fib should be in a time frame lesser than the discount old high that was retested. For example, if buying off a weekly high as support, look for a daily or four-hour PD array and an extension of 127 percent or 168 percent (or a perfect symmetrical price swing).

CLASSIC TUESDAY LOW OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 3 (BULLISH ORDER BLOCK)

TIMESTAMP: 00:04:42



For this scenario, the market is primarily bullish.

- The market trades down into a discount Market on Tuesday, specifically into a bullish order block.

- This order block can be monthly, weekly, daily, or a combination/overlap of these three time frames. It can also be a four-hour order block.

- This can occur when the market has already been trading higher, and the overall price move is expected to be significant and higher, possibly a multi-week scenario.

- This entry could be at a first swing grade, at the equilibrium price point, or a third swing grade.

- Third swing grades are generally the halfway point between equilibrium and the ultimate price objective, and typically do not involve a stop run immediately before the ultimate price move.

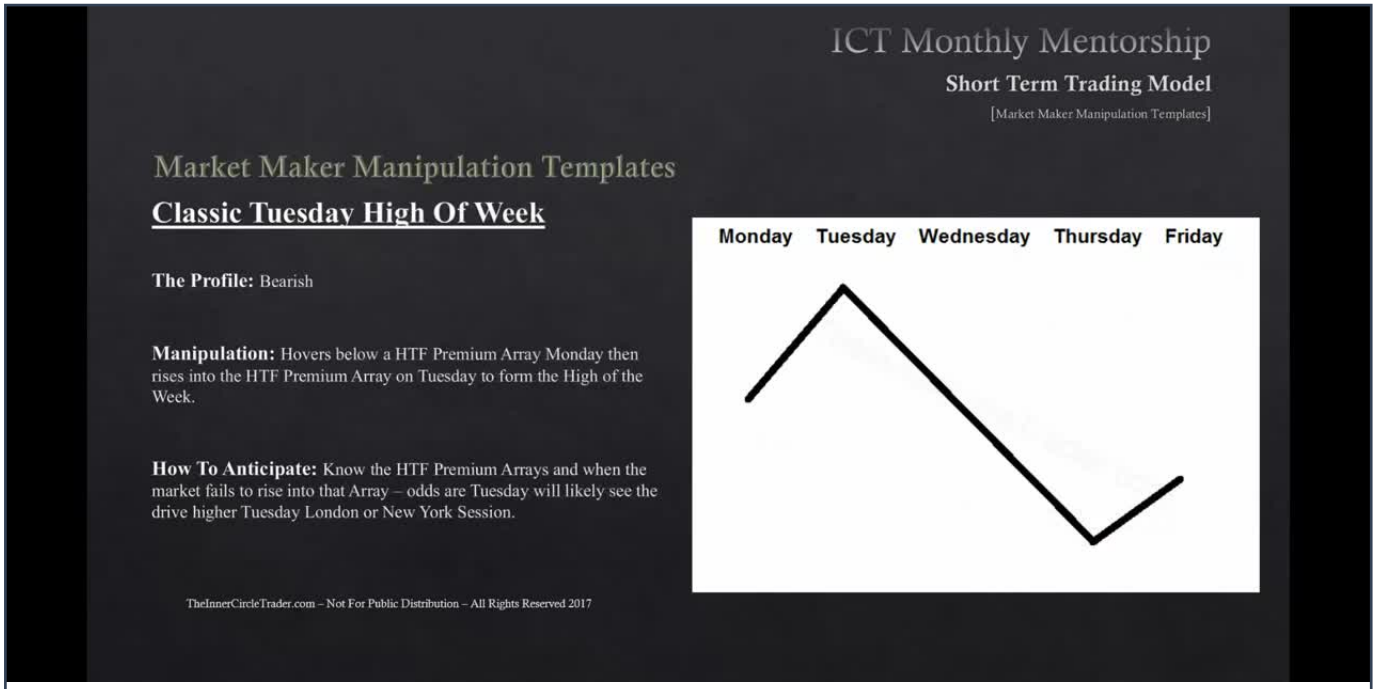
- Regardless of the time frame used for the bullish order block, the target is a premium Market PD array and/or Fib extension (127 percent or 168 percent, or a perfect symmetrical price swing - 100 percent duplication/measured move of the price swing).

- The target must be in a time frame lesser than what was used for the bullish order block entry. For example, if a weekly order block was used, target a daily or four-hour premium PD array.

- Fair value gaps or liquidity voids can also be instances where this trade materializes.

CLASSIC TUESDAY HIGH OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 1 (LIQUIDITY POOL)

TIMESTAMP: 00:07:28



This template is for a primarily bearish market.

- The market trades up on Tuesday into a premium Market.

- This premium comes in the form of an old monthly, weekly, or daily high.

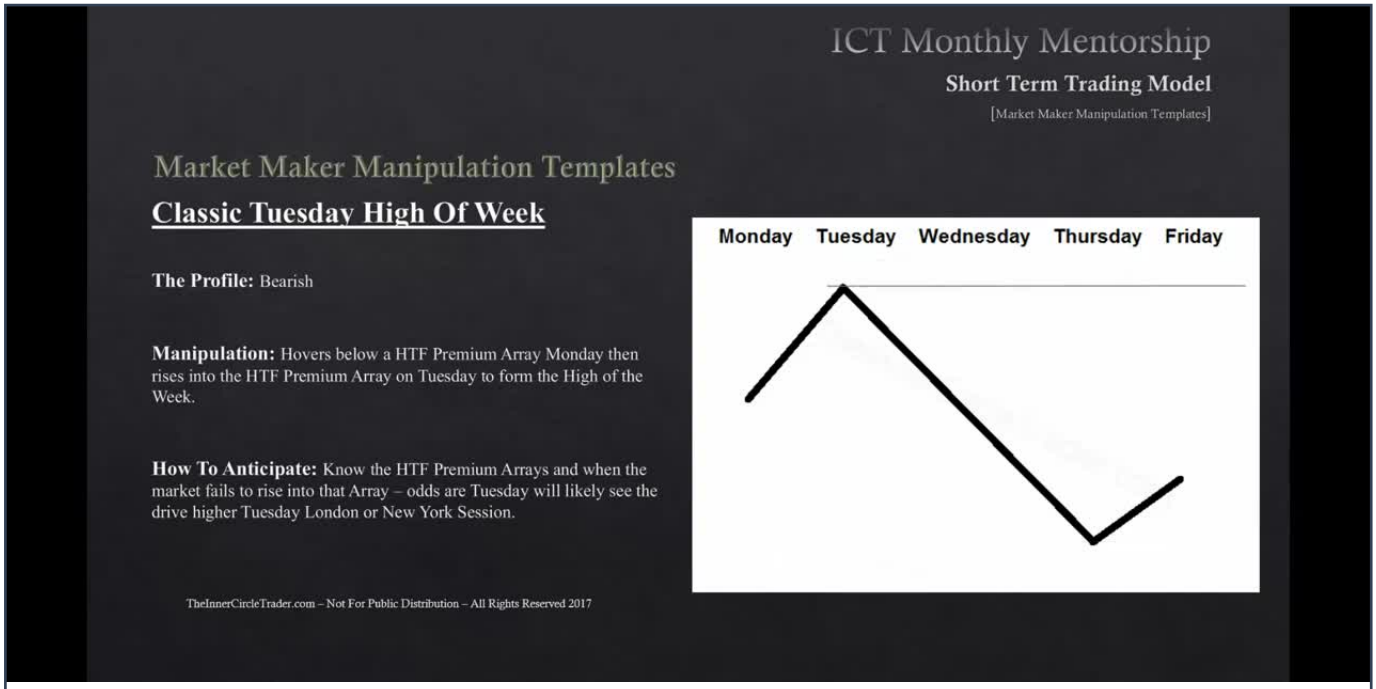
- The purpose is to run a liquidity pool, specifically running out buy stops above an old high.

- The trade is framed with an exit down into a discount Market PD array.

- Key: The target time frame should be lesser than the premium liquidity pool time frame used for the entry. For example, if selling short at a daily high (liquidity run on buy stops), look for a four-hour discount PD array as an objective. If using a weekly high for buy stop run, look for a daily or four-hour discount Market PD array.

CLASSIC TUESDAY HIGH OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 2 (RETEST OF OLD LOW AS RESISTANCE)

TIMESTAMP: 00:08:54



This is another scenario for a Classic Tuesday High of the Week, again in a bearish market condition.

- The market trades up into a premium market, specifically to an old monthly, weekly, or daily low.

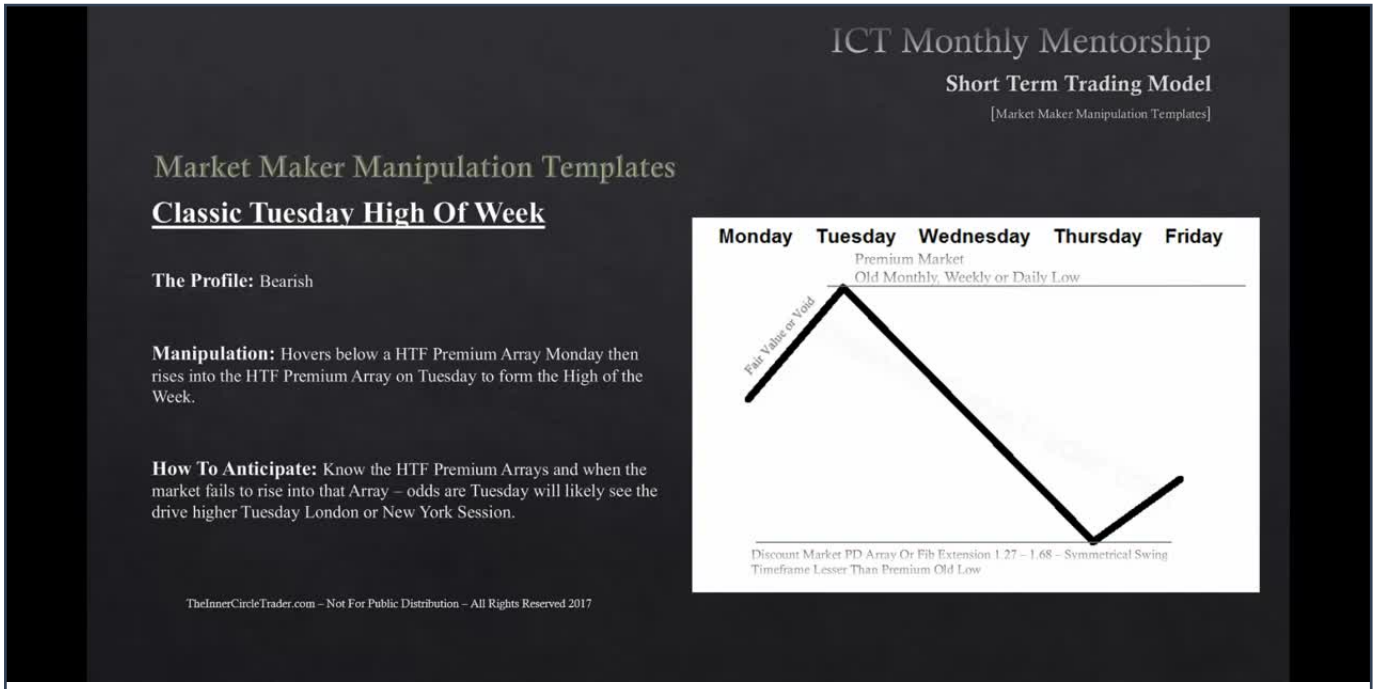
- This means the market has already broken down below a measure of Market structure or an old low, and is now coming back to retest that area as resistance.

- The target is a discount Market PD array and/or Fib extension (127 percent or 168 percent, or a perfect symmetrical price swing).

- This target should be in a time frame lesser than the premium old low retest. For example, if selling off a weekly low retested as resistance, look for a daily or four-hour discount Market PD array and an overlapping Fib extension.

- The move up initially in the beginning of the week is the price swing to be used for Fib projections. The fulcrum points for Fib anchoring will be shown in examples.

CLASSIC TUESDAY HIGH OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 3 (BEARISH ORDER BLOCK AND FAIR VALUE GAP)



This scenario involves a fair value gap or liquidity void that fills in before Tuesday highs form, trading back up to an old monthly, weekly, or daily low.

- The market moves up into a premium bearish order block (monthly, weekly, or daily).

- This can occur as a first swing grade, at equilibrium, or as a third swing grade entry, especially if a larger, longer-term price move lower is anticipated.

- The target is a discount Market PD array or Fib extension (127 percent or 168 percent, or a perfect symmetrical price swing/100 percent measured move).

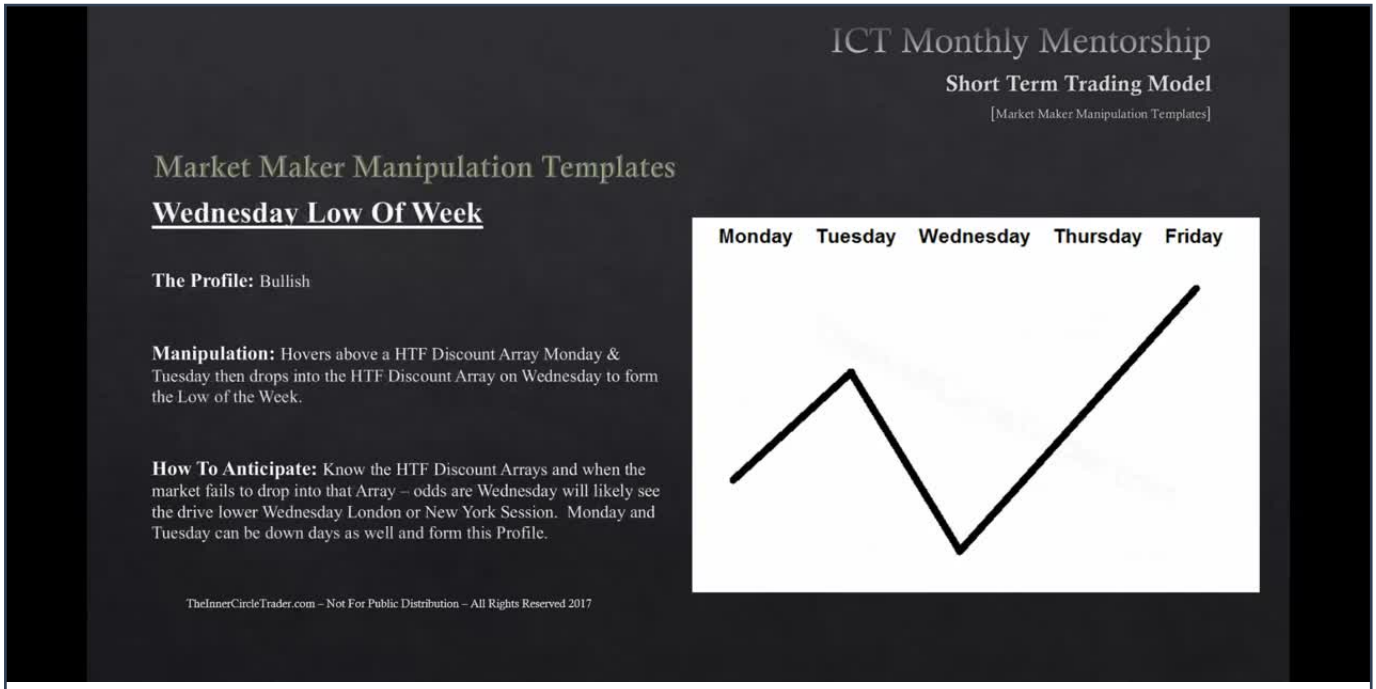
- The target must be in a time frame lesser than the bearish order block entry. For example, if selling off a daily bearish order block, look for a four-hour discount Market PD array.

- This target must overlap with the Fib projection from the fair value or liquidity void swing that went up into Tuesday. Measure the Fib from that low up to the high created on Tuesday, and project down for 127 percent or 168 percent extensions.

- If the Fib projections overlap and converge with a lesser time frame discount PD array, that defines the weekly target, and the position can be held until Thursday or Friday.

WEDNESDAY LOW OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 1 (LIQUIDITY POOL & REFLECTION PATTERN)

TIMESTAMP: 00:13:25



This market profile is bullish.

- The market generally shows a short-term low on Monday, trades up into Tuesday, then trades lower on Tuesday into Wednesday, forming the low of the week.

- The market trades down into a discount, potentially an old monthly, weekly, or daily low for a liquidity pool (running out sell stops).

- The market is expected to trade up into a premium Market PD array in a time frame lesser than the discount liquidity pool used for the long entry.

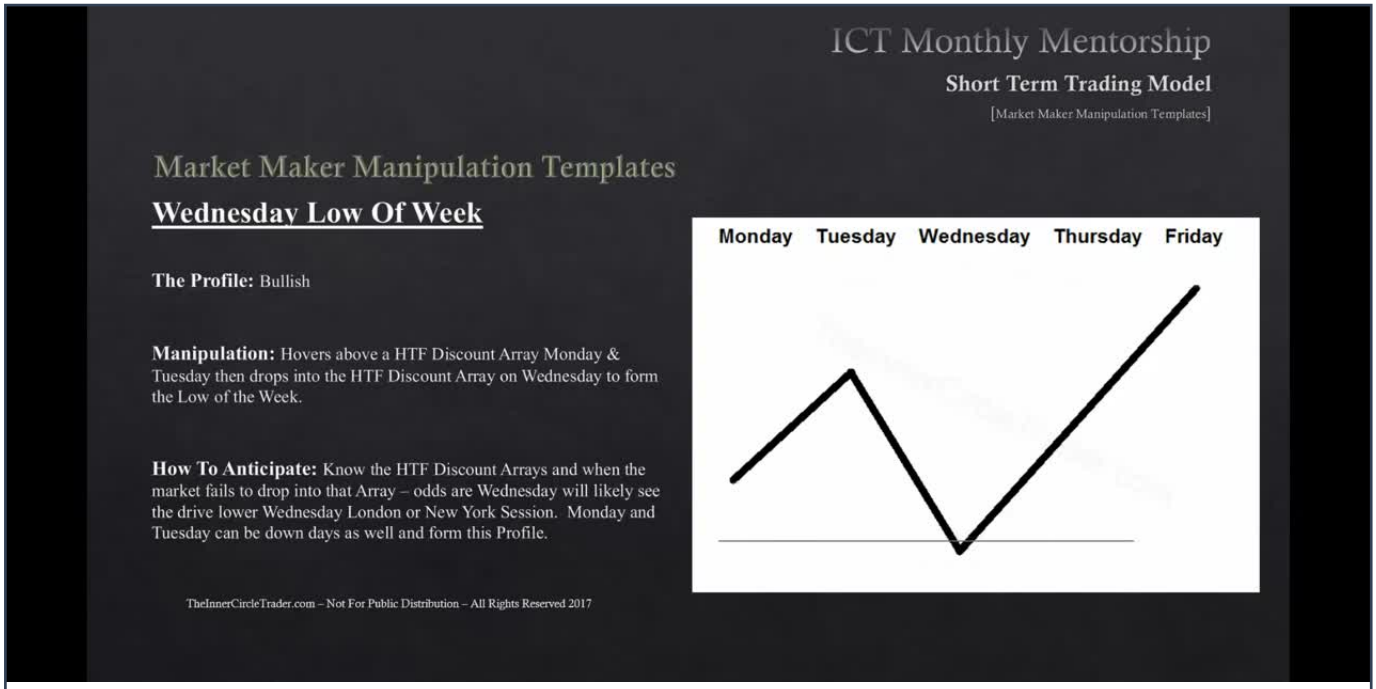
- This often frames a 'reflection pattern' (127 percent or 168 percent extension after running an old low).

- If sell stops below lows are taken out, expect the market to trade up into Thursday or Friday (preferably Friday) into a premium Market PD array.

- For a weekly move, expect to enter on the weekly low and exit at a daily or four-hour premium Market PD array.

WEDNESDAY LOW OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 2 (RETEST OF OLD HIGH AS SUPPORT)

TIMES PAUSE
00:15:09



Another scenario for Wednesday Low of the Week, for a bullish market.

- The market trades down into a discount Market, specifically retesting an old monthly, weekly, or daily high as support.

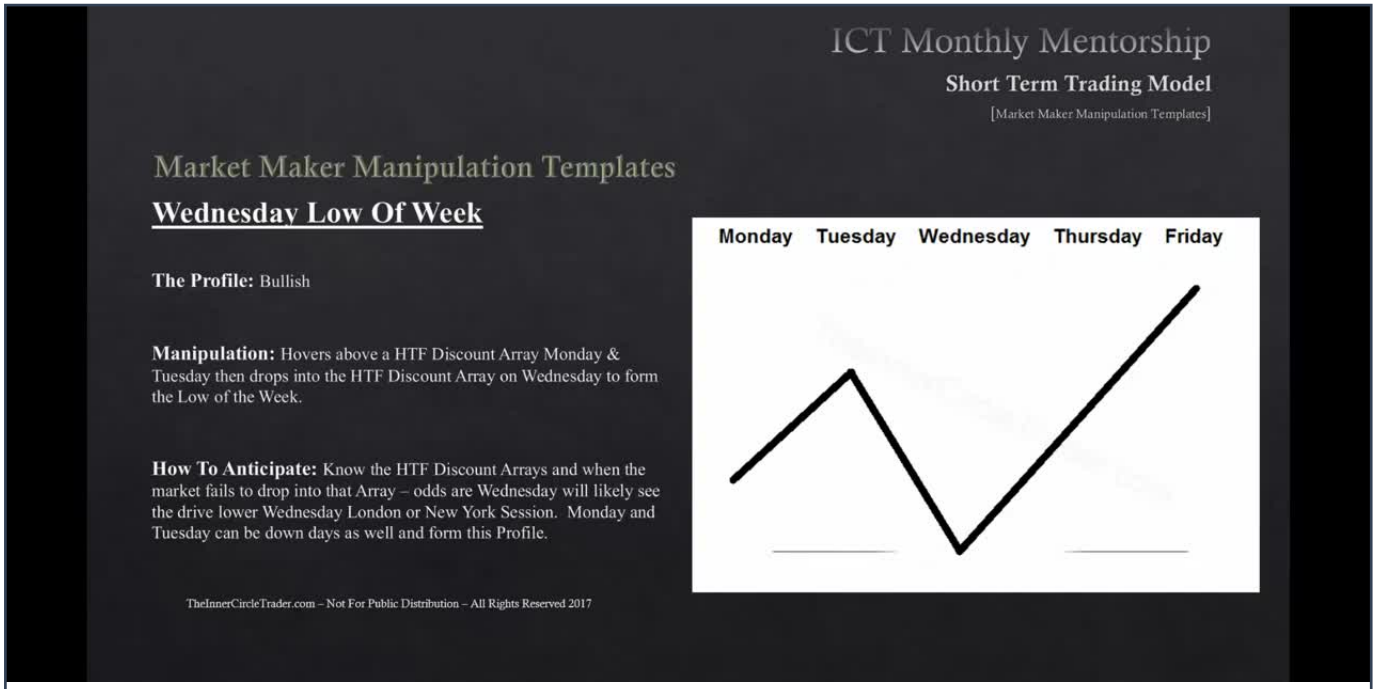
- This implies the market traded up, broke out, and is now coming back down. Monday might start with a small rally, but Tuesday trades lower into Wednesday to retest the old high.

- This entry is framed with the expectation of a rally up into Friday, targeting a premium Market PD array and/or Fib extension (127 percent, 168 percent, or a perfect symmetrical price swing).

- The target time frame should be lesser than the old high used for the long entry. For instance, if buying a monthly high retest, the premium target (PD array) would be seen on a weekly, daily, or four-hour chart.

- The key is finding where this lesser time frame PD array overlaps with the 127 percent or 168 percent Fib extensions, coupling it with a PD array contrary to the entry time frame.

WEDNESDAY LOW OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 3 (BULLISH ORDER BLOCK & SWING GRADES)



For a primarily bullish market, this scenario involves the market trading down into Wednesday into a discount Market.

- The market trades into a bullish order block (monthly, weekly, daily).

- This could be a first swing grade entry, for a longer-term multi-week move higher, where Wednesday offers the initial retracement for a long position.

- It could also occur at the equilibrium (halfway point) of the overall price move, or at the third swing grade (one-half between equilibrium and the ultimate target).

- Generally, at third swing grades, stop runs are less common, but shorter order blocks can still be traded.

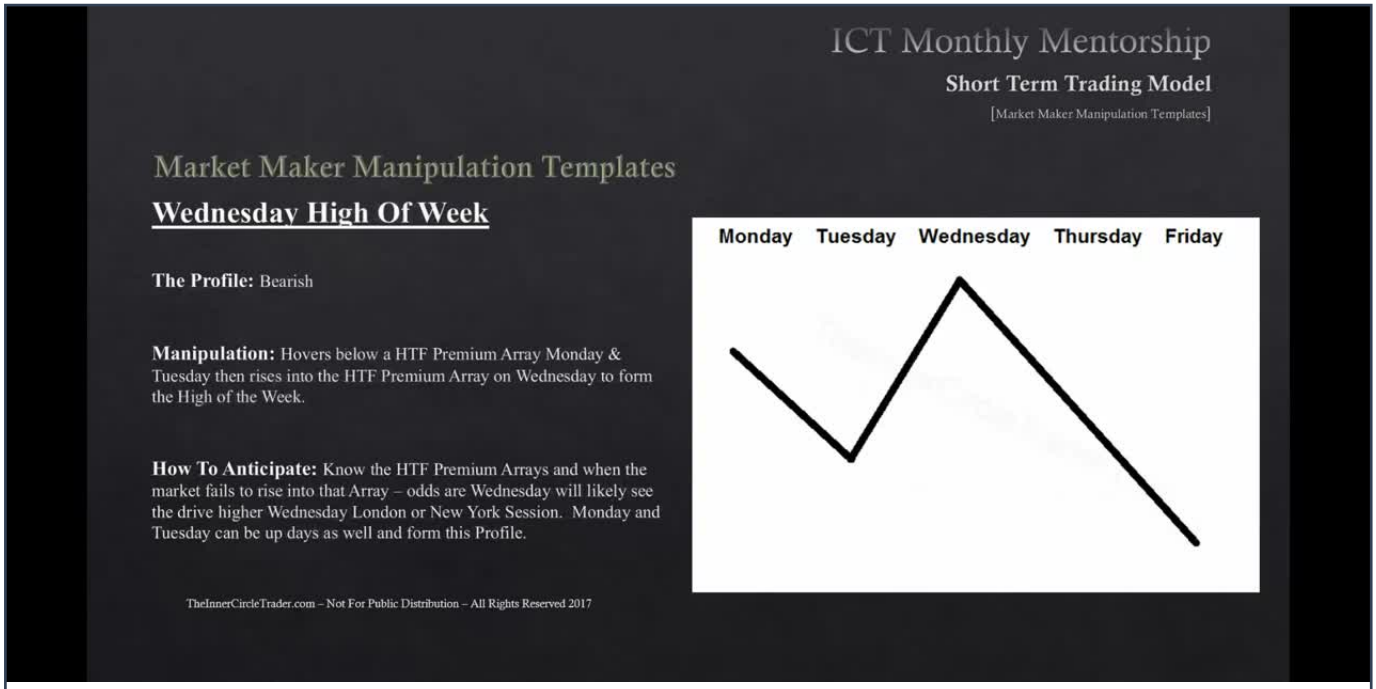
- The market could consolidate Sunday-Tuesday, then trade down on Wednesday into a discount order block, enabling a rally through Thursday into Friday.

- Regardless of the order block time frame (e.g., daily), the target is a premium Market PD array with an overlapping Fib (127 percent, 168 percent, or symmetrical price swing) in a lesser time frame (e.g., four-hour).

- The price swing used for Fib extensions (127 percent, 168 percent, or 100 percent duplication) is the run down to Wednesday's low.

WEDNESDAY HIGH OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 1 (LIQUIDITY POOL)

TIMESTAMP: 00:18:58



This template is for a bearish market environment.

- The market trades up into a premium Market on Wednesday, specifically into an old monthly, weekly, or daily high liquidity pool (running out an old high's buy stops).

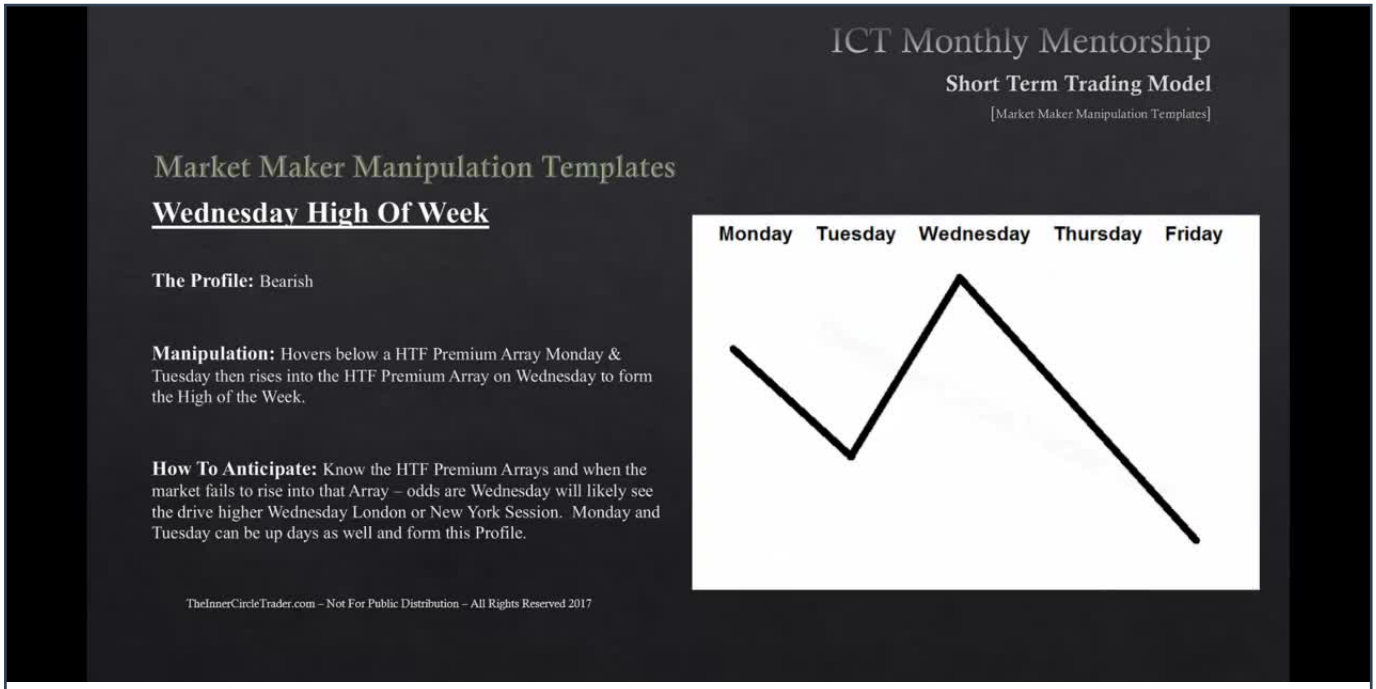
- This idea is framed with a move down into a discount Market PD array.

- The target time frame should be lesser than the premium liquidity pool used for the entry. For instance, if expecting a bearish market and the move up takes out a weekly high's buy stops, expect a daily or four-hour discount PD array as the objective for the week.

- This scenario can occur in an equilibrium area on a larger price move, especially for position or swing traders looking for longer than a one-week move, acting as a short-term high being run out (classic stop run).

WEDNESDAY HIGH OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 2 (FAIR VALUE GAP/RETEST OF OLD LOW AS RESISTANCE)

TIMESTAMP: 00:20:09



Another scenario for Wednesday High of the Week, for an overall bearish market.

- A fair value gap or liquidity void is filled, then the market runs through it for stops.

- This is a retest to an old low, returning to a premium Market in front of an old monthly, weekly, or daily low.

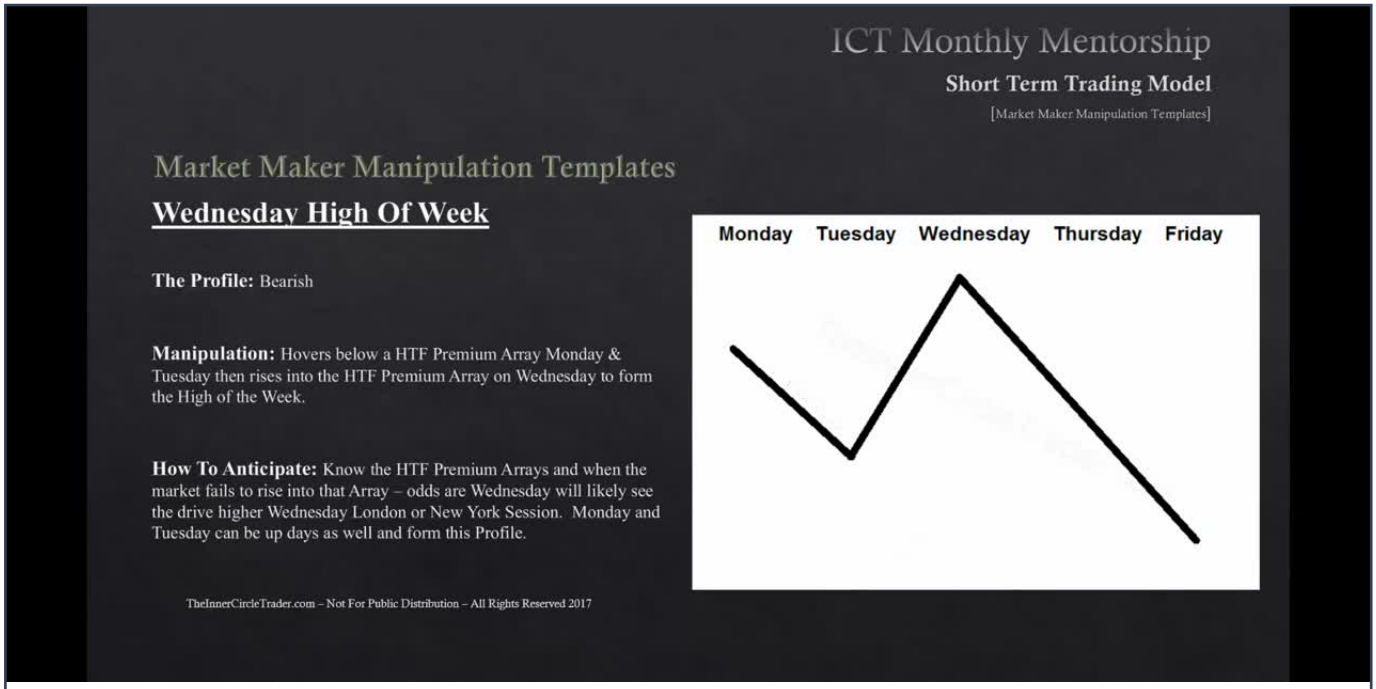
- The target is a discount Market PD array and/or a Fib extension (127 percent to 168 percent, or a perfect symmetrical price swing).

- The target time frame should be lesser than the premium old low retest. For example, if selling a monthly low retest as resistance on Wednesday, look for a weekly, daily, or four-hour discount PD array with an extension overlap.

- To anchor the Fib: Use Tuesday's low to Wednesday's high as the price swing. Projections below Tuesday's low (127 percent, 168 percent, or a 100 percent symmetrical duplication of that swing range) should converge with the discount PD array. This blends time and price for target identification.

WEDNESDAY HIGH OF THE WEEK - SCENARIO 3 (BEARISH ORDER BLOCK & SWING GRADES)

TIMESTAMP
00:22:12



For this scenario, the market is primarily bearish.

- The market trades up into Wednesday into a premium market, filling a fair value gap or liquidity void, or trading into a bearish order block (monthly, weekly, daily).

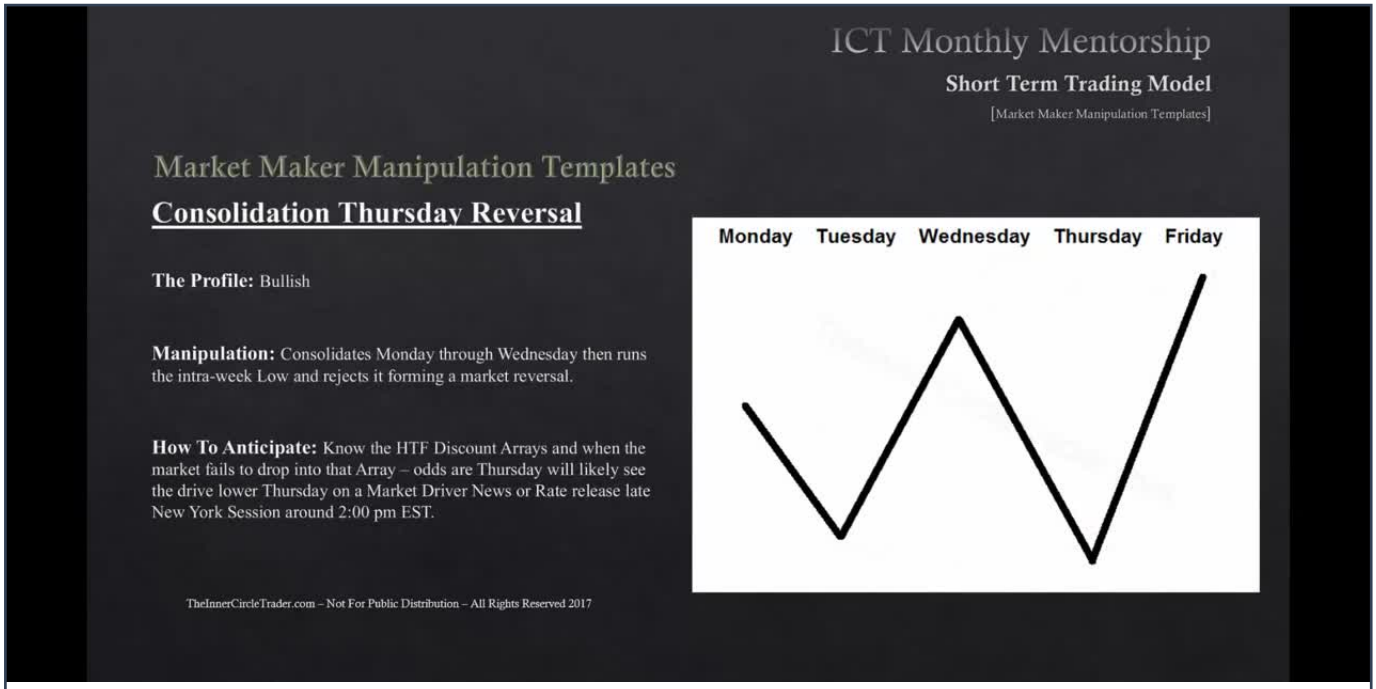
- This could be a first swing grade entry, or occur at equilibrium, or a third swing grade entry for a larger, longer-term price swing going lower.

- The target is a discount Market PD array or Fib extension (127 percent or 168 percent, or a perfect symmetrical price swing), preferably both overlapping.

- The target time frame should be lesser than the bearish order block used for the trade entry.

CONSOLIDATION THURSDAY REVERSAL - BULLISH (TURTLE SOUP LONG)

TIMESTAMP: 00:22:56



This is a bullish market profile.

- The market consolidates sideways from Sunday/Monday into Wednesday.

- On Thursday, the market trades down into a discount Market, often driven by high impact news (e.g., FOMC at 2 p.m. EST, or 8:30 a.m. EST employment data).

- Traders expect the market to shoot higher, but instead, it runs out sell stops below early-week lows (Monday/Tuesday).

- This false break below an old low becomes a 'turtle soup long' setup.

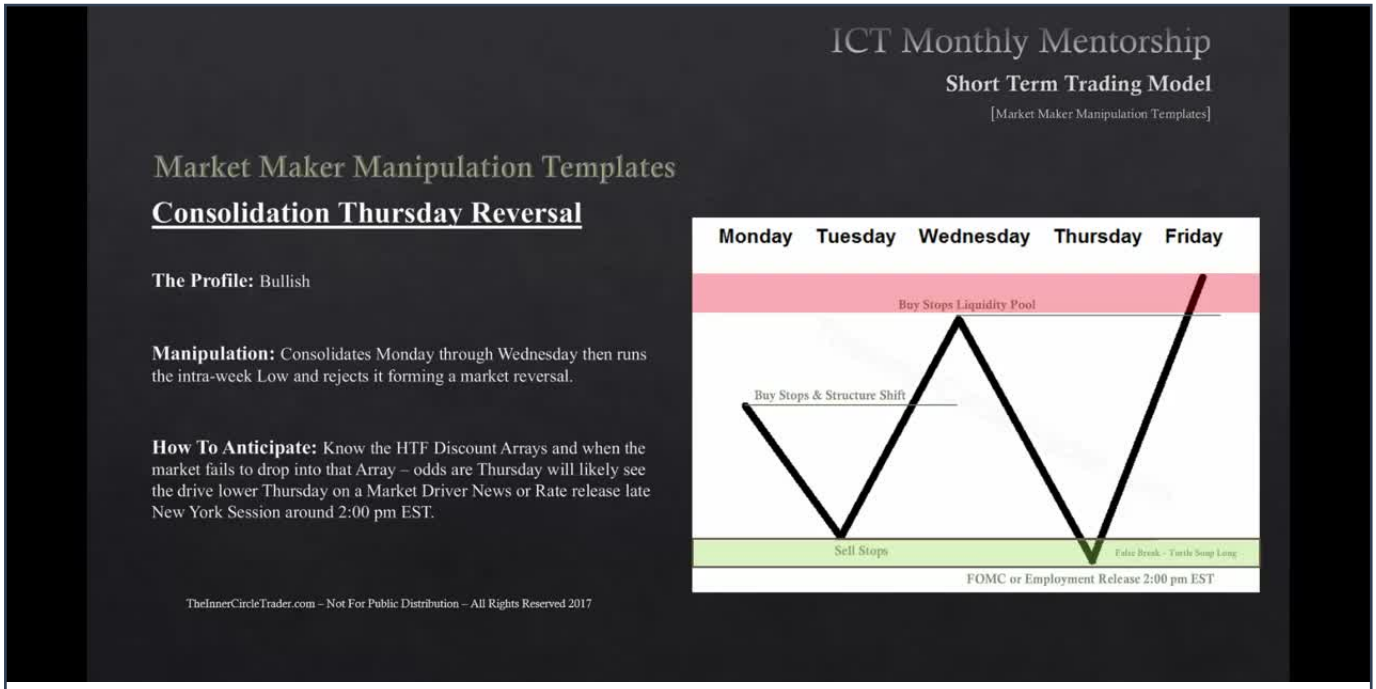
- The objective is for the market to trade up to the weekly buy stops, which is the liquidity pool above the intra-week highs.

- This is a 'one shot one kill' setup: Buy the break below the weekly low (Monday/Tuesday) on the heels of news. Target the buy stops for the intraday or intra-week high.

- Extreme caution is advised for FOMC events due to potential whipsaws; use very small positions and limit orders below the low.

CONSOLIDATION THURSDAY REVERSAL - BEARISH (TURTLE SOUP SHORT)

TIMESTAMP: 00:25:19



This template is for a bearish market environment.

- Earlier in the week, it appears the market is taking out sell stops or has had a bullish market structure shift.

- From Wednesday into Thursday, the market trades up into a premium Market, running out buy stops (intra-week highs).

- This is often driven by high impact news (e.g., FOMC 2 p.m. EST, or 8:30 a.m. EST employment data).

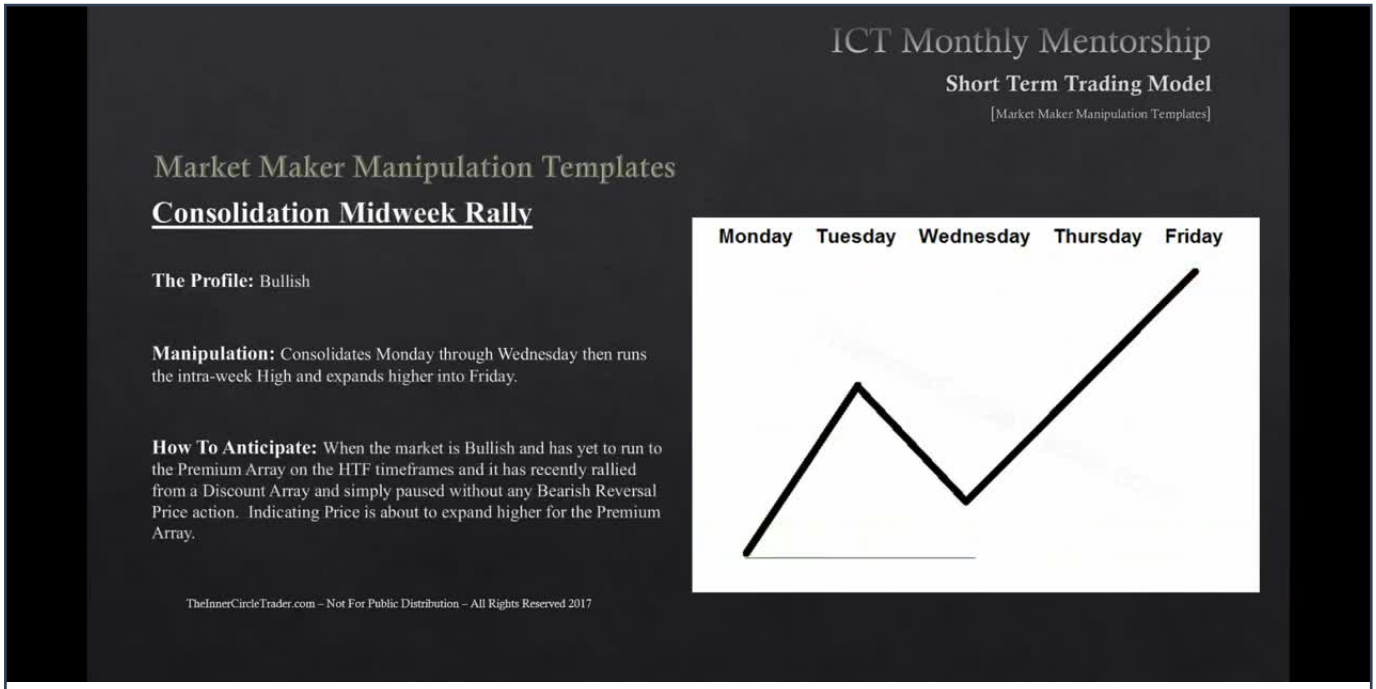
- The market causes a false break above the intra-week high; this is a 'turtle soup short' setup.

- The objective is to target the sell stops below the intra-week low for the liquidity pool.

- The one shot one kill setup is framed only Thursday going into Friday, focusing on one day's worth of action.

CONSOLIDATION MIDWEEK RALLY - BULLISH (FIB ANCHORING)

TIMESTAMP: 00:26:13



This is a bullish market profile.

- The market starts bullish on Monday.

- A retracement occurs on Tuesday, trading down into Wednesday into a discount fair value gap, liquidity void, or bullish order block.

- A high or medium impact news event on Wednesday (London or New York session) acts as a catalyst.

- The swing projection fulcrum point is the intra-week high formed on Tuesday (or Monday's high).

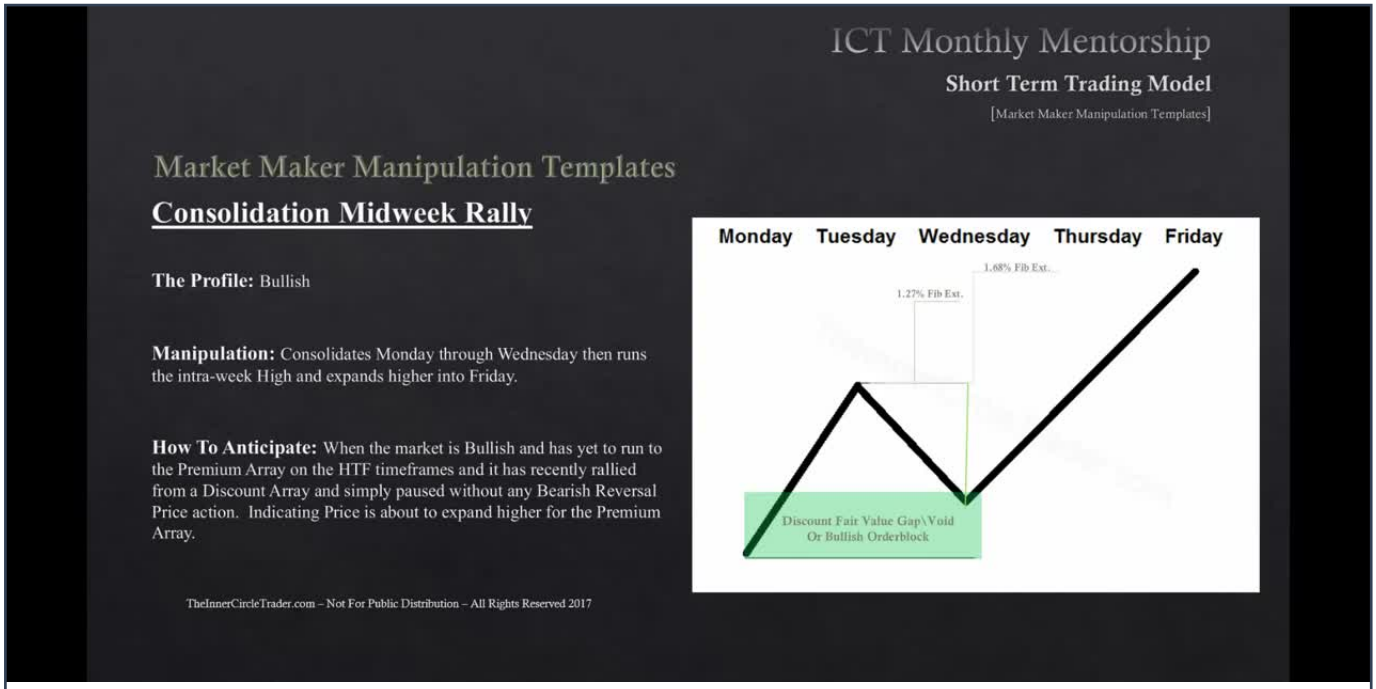
- The target is a premium PD array (monthly, weekly, or daily) with converging Fib extensions of 127 percent and/or 168 percent, or a perfect measured swing projection.

- To anchor the Fib: Pull the Fib from the highest high (fulcrum point) down to where the market trades into the order block or discount PD array. This range will project the swing up into the premium PD arrays.

- The ultimate target is a time frame lesser than the one used for the bullish order block entry (e.g., if daily OB, target a four-hour premium PD array) that overlaps with 127 percent or 168 percent Fib extensions.

CONSOLIDATION MIDWEEK RALLY - BULLISH (FIB OVERLAP & CONFLUENCE)

TIMESTAMP: 00:28:52



Continuing with the Consolidation Midweek Rally - Bullish scenario:

- The Fib overlap levels are based on the time frame of entry.

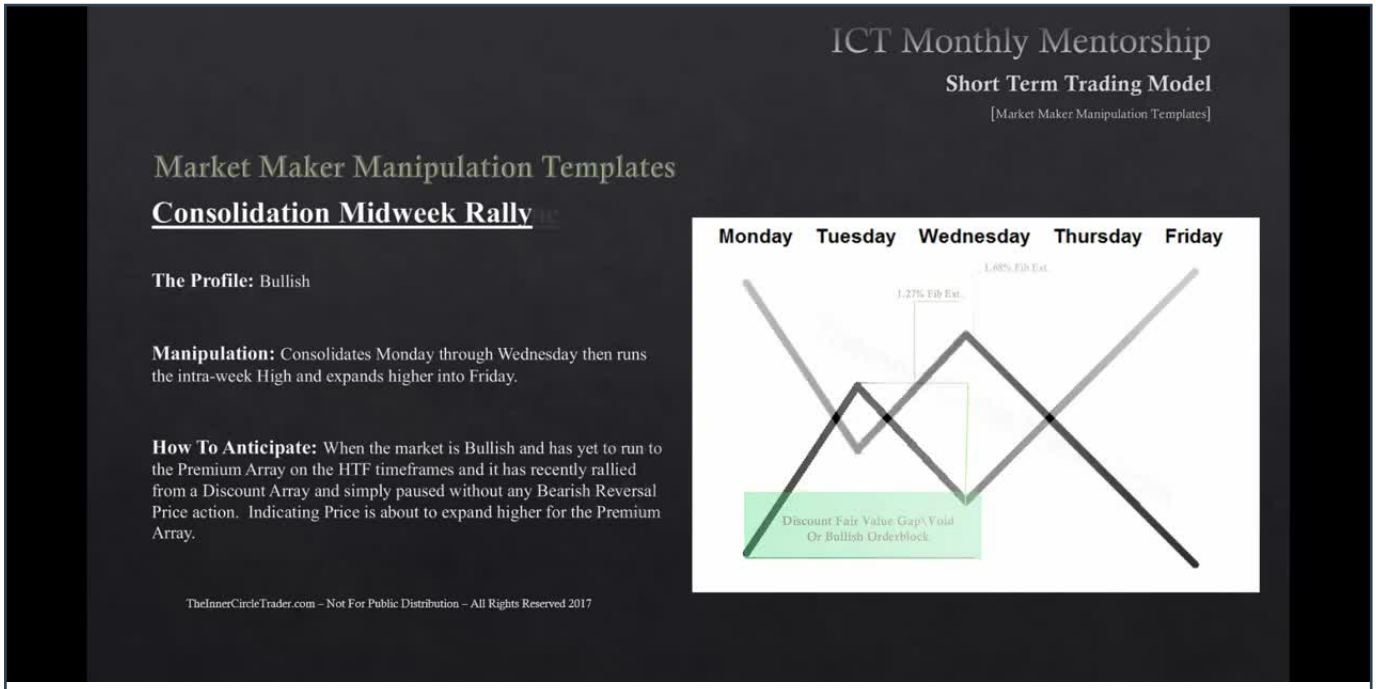
- Look for a lower time frame PD array in a premium range to overlap with the 127 percent and 168 percent Fib extensions.

- When both conditions are met (lesser time frame premium PD array and overlapping Fib extensions), there is a high confluence level.

- This indicates where the algorithm (algo) may very easily trade to for the target, representing the completion of the move.

CONSOLIDATION MIDWEEK DECLINE - BEARISH (FIB ANCHORING)

TIMESTAMP: 00:29:19



This is a bearish market environment.

- On Wednesday (or Tuesday), the market trades up into a premium fair value gap, liquidity void, or bearish order block.

- A high or medium impact news event occurs on Wednesday (London or New York open) as a catalyst.

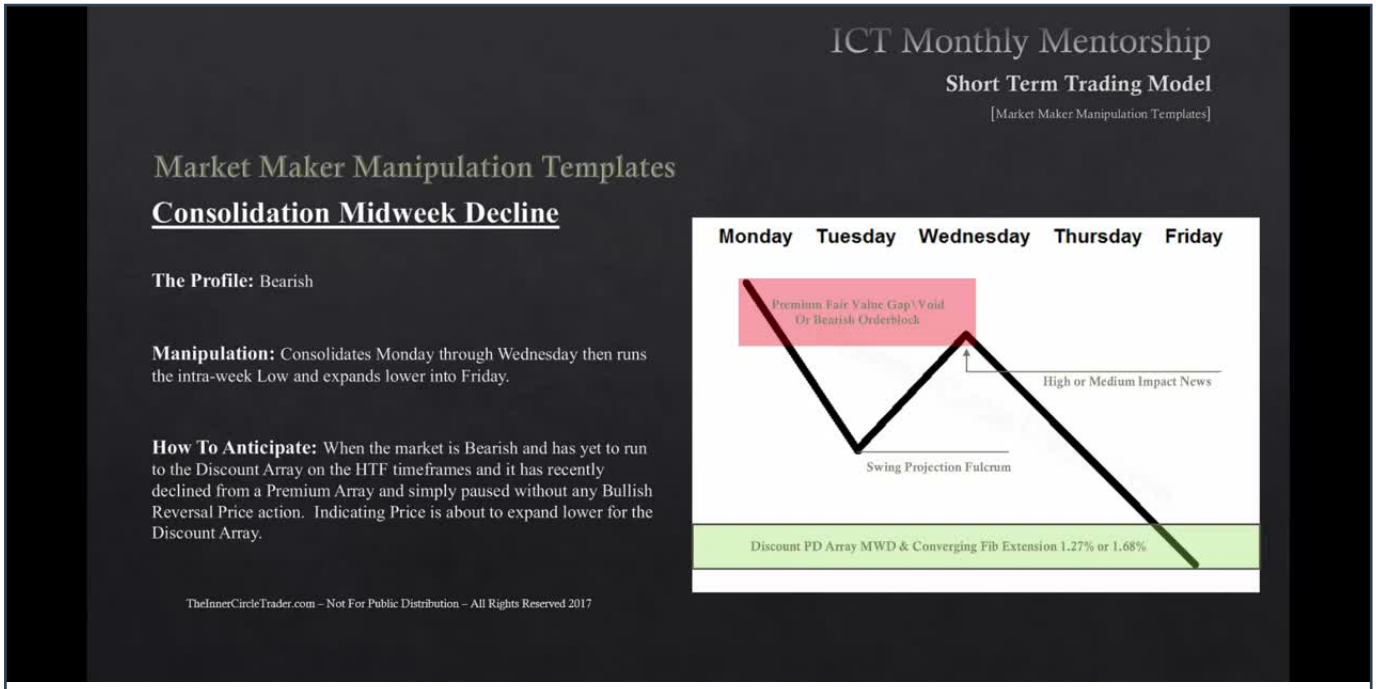
- There is a swing projection fulcrum point.

- The market is expected to trade down to a discount PD array (monthly, weekly, daily) with converging Fib extensions of 127 percent or 168 percent, or a perfect symmetrical price swing (100 percent measured move).

- Similar to the bullish scenario, the Fib is anchored to project the decline.

CONSOLIDATION MIDWEEK DECLINE - BEARISH (FIB CALCULATION EXAMPLE)

TIMESTAMP: 00:30:09



This explains the calculation for the Consolidation Midweek Decline - Bearish scenario:

- The premium fair value gap, liquidity void, or bearish order block is the sell short entry point in a bearish market.

- The swing projection fulcrum point is used to measure down to the target.

- The 127 percent and 168 percent extensions are projected down from Wednesday's high.

- To calculate manually: Identify Wednesday's highest high and Tuesday's lowest low (or the lowest low between Monday's open and Wednesday's high).

- Take the range (in Pips) from Tuesday's low to Wednesday's high.

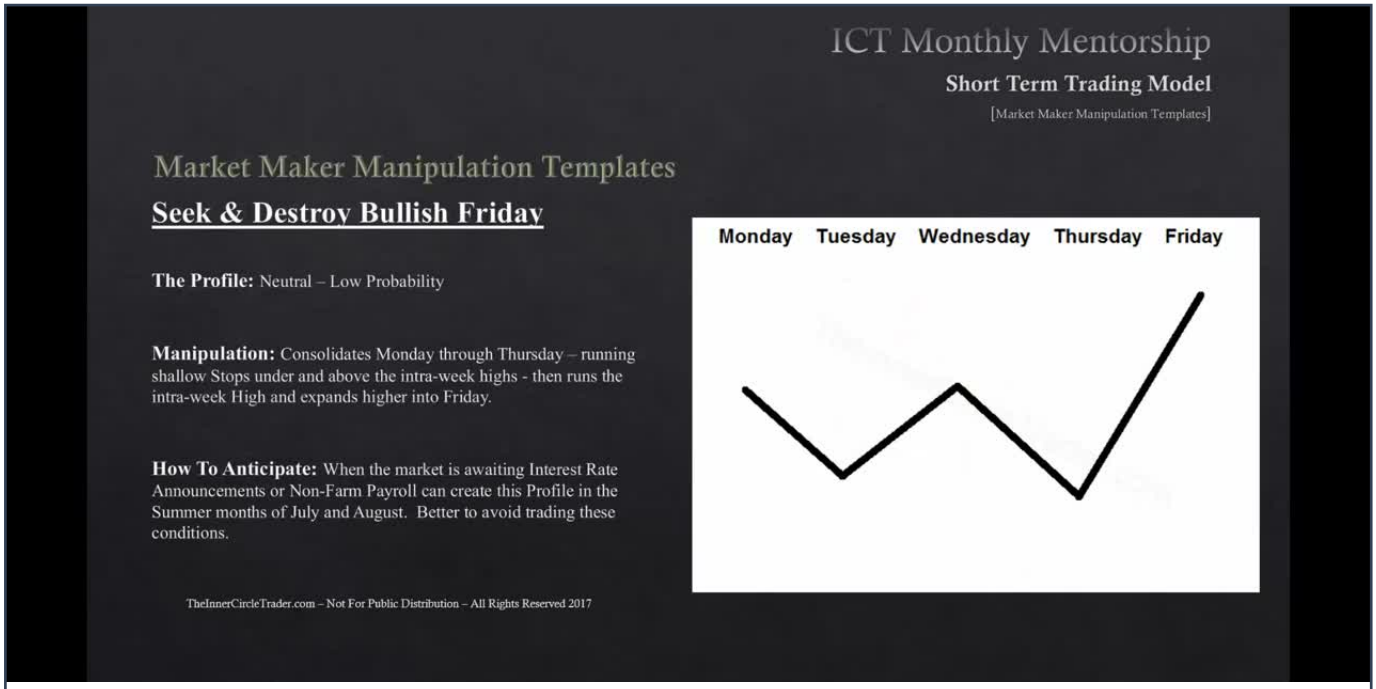
- Multiply this range by 1.27 for the 127 percent extension. Subtract this value from Wednesday's high.

- Multiply this range by 1.68 for the 168 percent extension. Subtract this value from Wednesday's high.

- This provides the Fibonacci extension levels, which should converge with the discount PD array, for example, a weekly, daily, or four-hour discount PD array if the entry was based on a monthly high.

CONSOLIDATION DESTROY BULLISH FRIDAY (LOW PROBABILITY)

TIMESTAMP: 00:31:46



This is a low probability or neutral condition, generally for observation, not active trading.

- The market creates small consolidation throughout the week, going into Thursday.

- A liquidity pool of sell stops forms intra-week.

- High or medium impact news on Thursday (FOMC or employment decision) is anticipated to cause a sell stop raid below the lows of the week.

- Intra-week buy stops are then determined.

- The result is a liquidity run to a daily or weekly premium PD array, creating a new weekly range high that hadn't been traded to so far that week.

- The move is aggressive and speedy to this level.

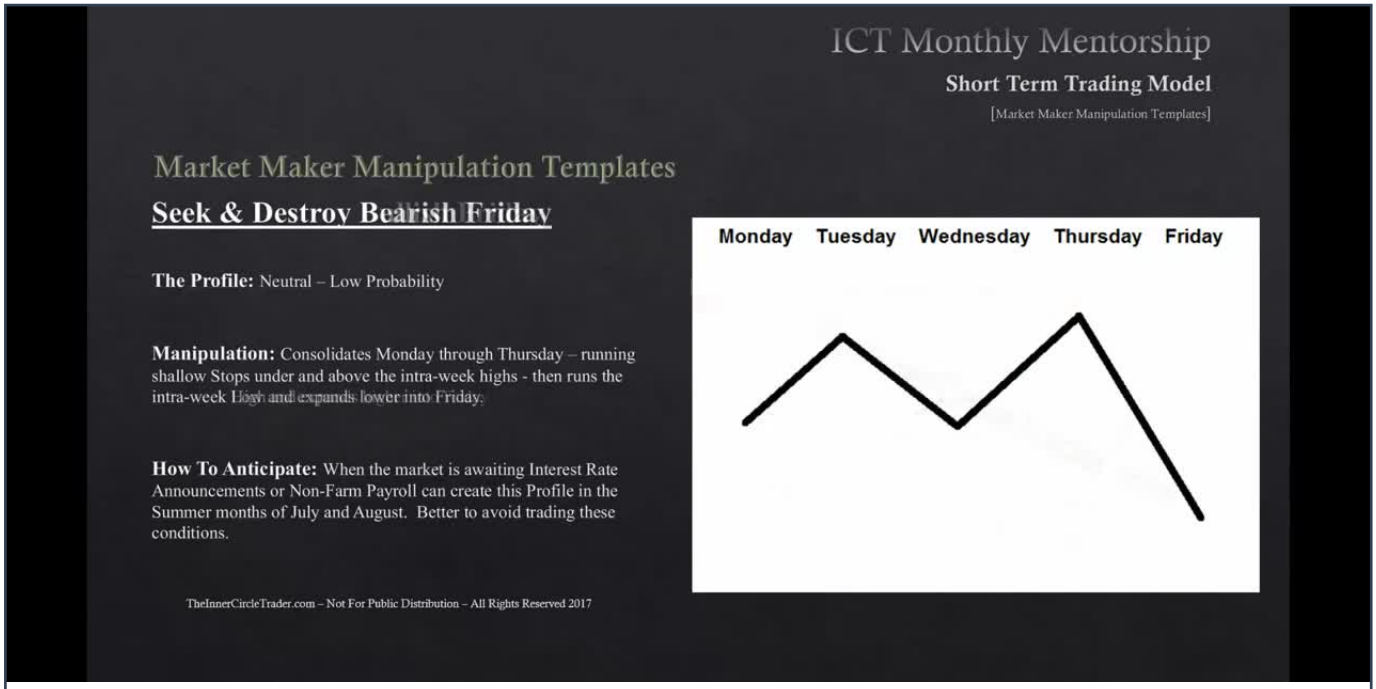
- This can occur in both bullish and bearish markets. If a higher time frame breaks out but fails to move lower, a Thursday news event can aggressively send it higher.

- This is one of the hardest templates to trade. If consolidation and whipsaws are present, it's better to stay on the sidelines.

- The template is useful because once the market reaches a daily or weekly premium PD array, a potential reversal is expected.

CONSOLIDATION DESTROY BEARISH FRIDAY (LOW PROBABILITY)

TIMESTAMP: 00:34:27



Again, this is a neutral, low probability profile and market manipulation template, for observation rather than trading.

- The market creates consolidation from Monday through Wednesday, building a liquidity pool of buy stops intra-week.

- On Thursday, the market is anticipated to be taken up to this level, taking out the buy stops.

- A high or medium impact news event (e.g., FOMC or employment numbers) is usually the catalyst.

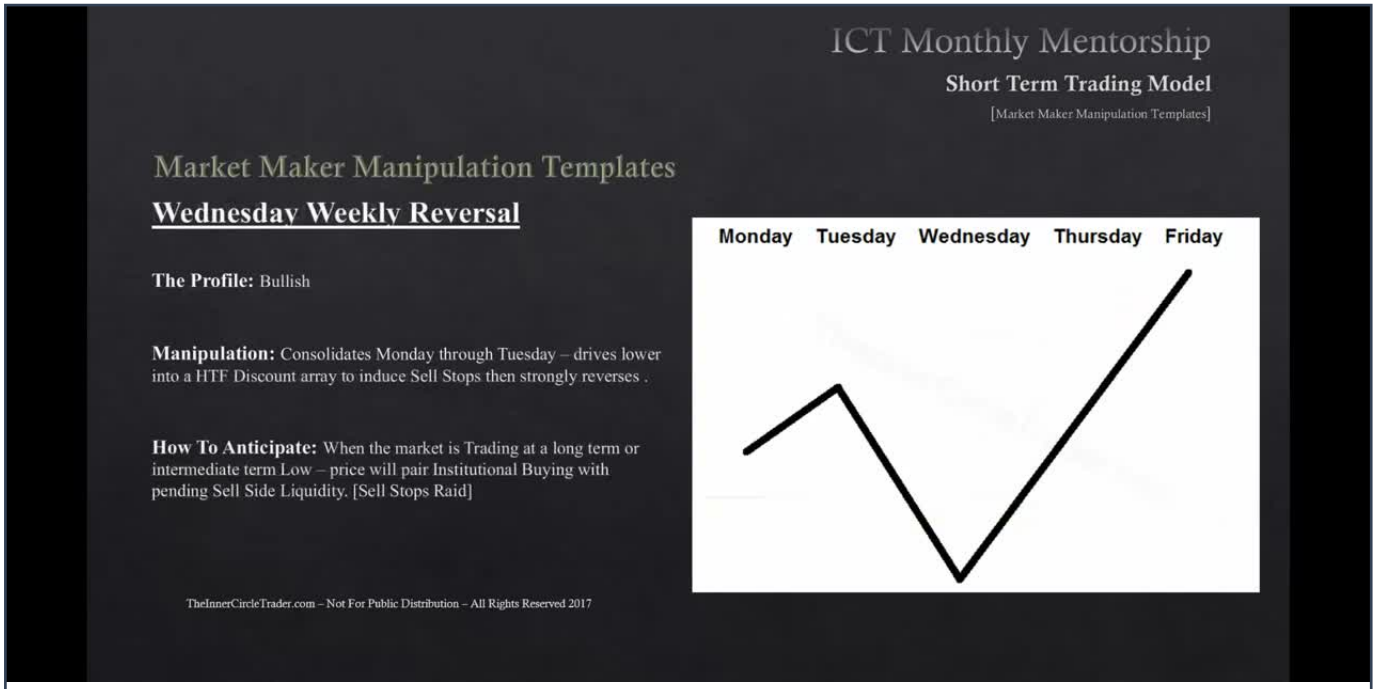
- After the buy stop raid, the market will run the intra-week sell stops and ultimately target a liquidity run to a daily and/or weekly discount PD array.

- The purpose of observing this is to identify when the market unfolds into a higher time frame PD array (daily or weekly discount PD array).

- When this occurs, a potential reversal is expected.

WEDNESDAY WEEKLY REVERSAL - BULLISH

TIMESTAMP:
00:36:00



This differs from the 'Wednesday Low of the Week' templates.

- An old low or retail support level is identified.

- High or medium impact news on Wednesday drives price down below that level, running liquidity.

- This typically occurs on a higher time frame basis (e.g., weekly or monthly support level).

- The market 'discounts' the news and reverses, moving aggressively higher.

- A Fibonacci extension of 127 percent or 168 percent (or a perfect symmetrical price swing, though 127 percent/168 percent are more common) is observed.

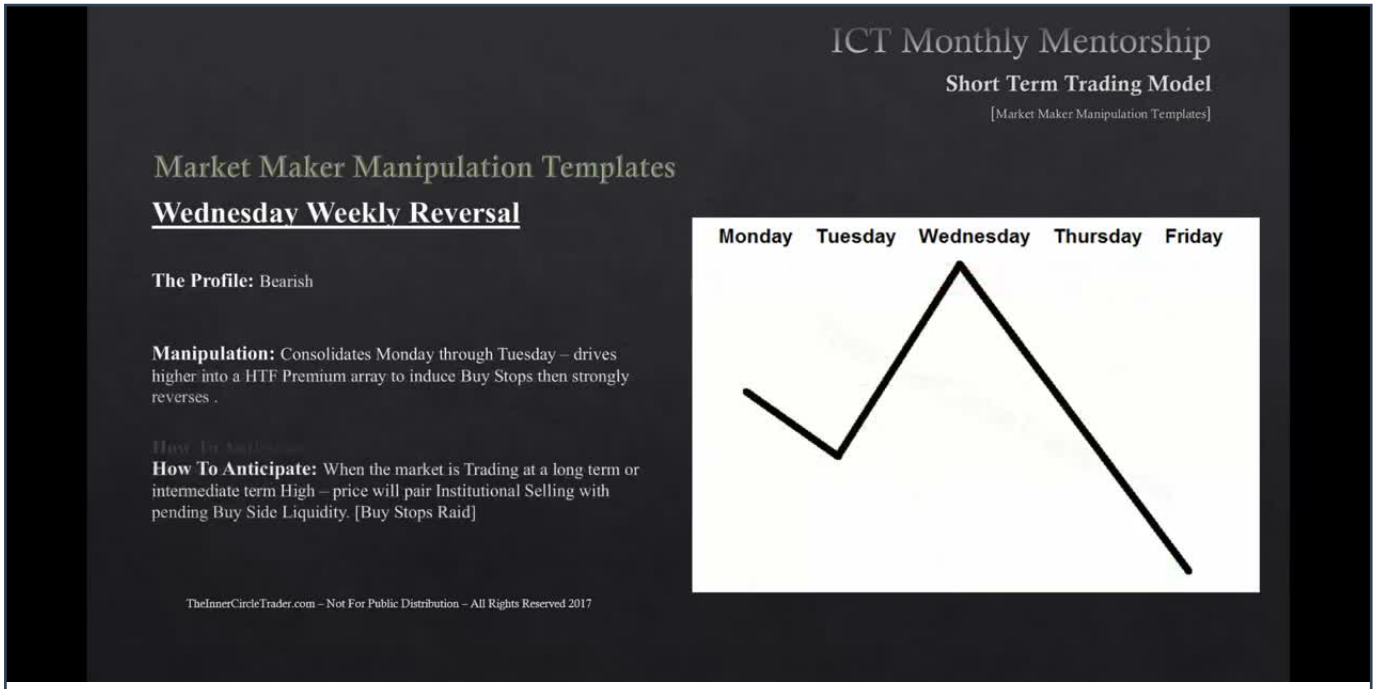
- The Fib extension is measured from the old low/retail support rally up into Tuesday's high, projected down to measure the extension.

- The market usually finds its way into a monthly, weekly, or daily discount array.

- Use the swing projection fulcrum point to project up to a 127 percent or 168 percent extension, overlapping with a weekly or daily premium PD array as a target.

WEDNESDAY WEEKLY REVERSAL - BEARISH

TIMESTAMP: 00:37:23



This is the bearish version of the Wednesday Weekly Reversal.

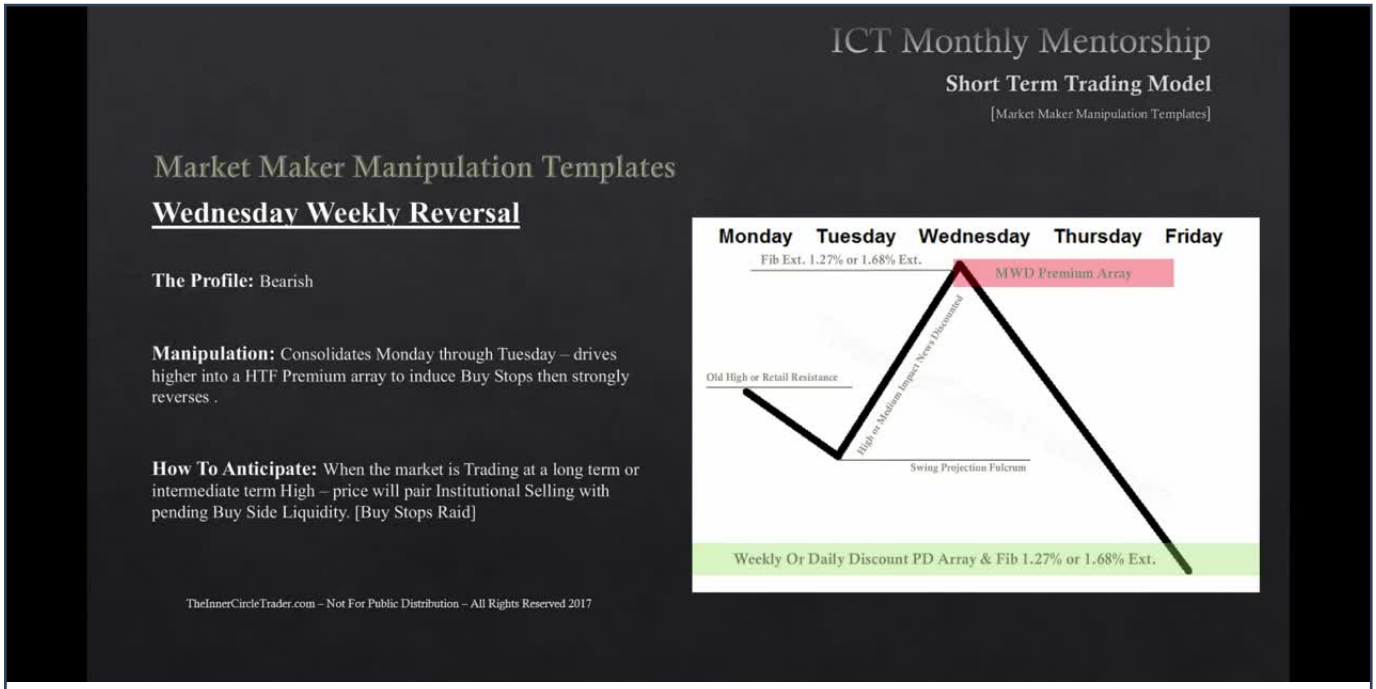
- An old high or retail resistance level is identified.

- High or medium impact news on Wednesday runs price above it.

- The market rejects or 'discounts' that news event and reverses, moving aggressively lower.

- A Fibonacci extension of 127 percent or 168 percent (or a perfect symmetrical price swing) is observed, coinciding with a monthly, weekly, or daily premium array.

- The market will then look to move below the swing projection fulcrum point down into a weekly or daily discount PD array, overlapping with a Fibonacci extension of 127 percent or 168 percent.



This collection of templates is the 'playbook' for finding 'one shot one kill' setups.

- The weekly range will generally fit one of these templates.

- Your higher time frame information from January should already establish a bullish or bearish bias.

- If bullish, focus on bullish profiles and look for the tell-tale signs and manipulation characteristics described.

- If bearish, focus on bearish profiles and look for the tell-tale signs and manipulation characteristics described.

- By blending weekly profiles with manipulation factors, market movements can appear almost scripted.

- The key is to identify the template. It's not critical to catch the exact highest high or lowest low of the week on Tuesday or Wednesday.

- Once the weekly range is defined and characteristics outline a potential direction into Friday's close, that itself can be a 'one shot one kill' opportunity, even if taken on the back end of the week.

- A 'one shot one kill' aims for a weekly objective (e.g., 50 to 75 Pips).

- If the characteristics described in Lesson 2 and Lesson 3 are not obvious or in alignment, it's best to sit on hands, day trade, scalp, or do nothing.

- To study: Pick any currency pair, go through three to four months of hourly charts, and analyze each weekly profile and how manipulation formed that range. Observe how easy it is to reach profit objectives using lesser time frames for exits than entries.

- This requires study to internalize these templates as the market's operational framework.